

crtfy Student 12 Month Product Plan

Last updated: 2026-06-04

Executive Direction

crtfy Student should become the best admissions operating layer in the market.

The product should not become a SIS, a campaign builder, a chatbot platform, an event platform, or a financial-aid processing system. Those categories create implementation drag and pull the product away from the admissions work that matters most. crtfy Student should win as the admissions operating system that tells teams:

- who needs work now
- what is blocking movement
- what evidence is trusted
- what decision can be defended
- who is likely to enroll
- what handoff is at risk

The strategic wedge is transcript-led intelligence. The broader market position is admissions execution.

Market Thesis

Colleges and universities do not need another place to store student records. They need an operating system for the messy handoffs between inquiry, application completion, document processing, review, decision, yield, and enrollment handoff.

The market is fragmented across:

- Admissions CRMs such as Slate and Element451.
- General CRMs and marketing tools such as Salesforce and HubSpot.
- SIS platforms such as Banner, Colleague, PeopleSoft, Jenzabar, and Workday Student.
- Document imaging systems.
- Transcript services.
- Financial aid systems.

- Departmental spreadsheets.
- Manual email and call workflows.

crtfy Student should be able to coexist with those systems at larger institutions and replace the admissions CRM layer at smaller institutions that cannot afford or operate a separate Slate or Element451 instance.

Product Positioning

The simple claim:

crtfy Student gets applications completed faster, decisions made faster, and deposits protected better.

The sharper category claim:

crtfy Student is the Admissions Operating System for modern enrollment teams.

The buyer-friendly shorthand:

A higher-ed CRM and so much more.

Use this shorthand when speaking to smaller schools that need one affordable admissions system. For larger schools, sharpen the message around coexistence:

The operating layer above your CRM and SIS that turns admissions data into completed work.

Brand Narrative

crtfy Student should own the phrase *Admissions Operating System*.

That phrase is broader and stronger than CRM. A CRM mostly manages contacts, communication history, campaigns, and pipeline records. An admissions operating system manages the actual work of enrollment:

- inquiries and applicants
- student context
- checklist completion
- transcript and document processing
- duplicate cleanup
- trust and provenance

- transfer evidence
- review readiness
- decision packets
- counselor work
- admitted-student yield
- melt prevention
- cross-office handoff
- operational reporting

The market message should be:

crtfy Student is the Admissions Operating System: a higher-ed CRM, transcript intelligence platform, decision workspace, and enrollment workflow engine in one.

That does not mean crtfy Student becomes everything. It means the product becomes the admissions team's daily system of action while integrating with marketing, SIS, financial aid, and communication tools where those systems are better suited.

Messaging Pillars

1. Higher-Ed CRM

For smaller schools, crtfy Student should replace a traditional admissions CRM for core admissions operations:

- inquiry and applicant records
- owner assignment
- source attribution
- interaction history
- application status
- checklist state
- admissions pipeline
- counselor queue
- basic operational reporting

2. Transcript Intelligence

crtfy Student should be best in market at turning transcript evidence into action:

- transcript intake

- parsing and normalization
- document-to-student matching
- checklist automation
- transfer credit confidence
- articulation gap routing
- academic evidence summaries

3. Decision Workspace

crtfy Student should help schools make faster, more defensible decisions:

- readiness
- recommendation generation
- evidence review
- trust posture
- decision packet snapshots
- release gates
- audit history

4. Enrollment Workflow Engine

crtfy Student should coordinate the work that normally lives in spreadsheets:

- Today's Work
- incomplete-app follow-up
- document exceptions
- special-case routing
- admitted-student interventions
- melt milestones
- handoff status

5. Integration Layer

crtfy Student should connect the ecosystem without becoming the SIS or marketing suite:

- HubSpot for marketing automation
- SIS for official student and registration records
- financial aid systems for aid processing
- communication systems for deliverability
- document stores and transcript providers for intake

The anti-positioning:

- We are not the SIS.
- We are not the email marketing platform.
- We are not the student portal of record.
- We are not the financial-aid system.
- We are not replacing institutional governance.

The positive positioning:

- We make existing systems smarter.
- We can replace Slate or Element451 for admissions operations when a school wants one admissions system instead of a CRM plus crtfy Student.
- We turn transcript evidence into enrollment action.
- We give staff one daily queue for work that can actually move.
- We provide explainable decisions and audit-ready trust posture.
- We expose handoff risk before students fall through the cracks.

Ideal Customer Profile

Primary ICP

Institutions with meaningful transcript, transfer, incomplete-application, or decision-latency pain:

- regional public universities
- community colleges with integrated enrollment services
- private colleges with high-touch admissions teams
- transfer-heavy institutions
- online, adult, military, or degree-completion programs
- graduate schools with decentralized program review

Strongest First Buyer

The first buyer is likely an enrollment leader or admissions operations leader who is accountable for:

- application completion
- document turnaround
- decision speed
- transfer yield
- admitted-student conversion

- operational staffing pressure
- trust, provenance, and audit risk

First Daily Users

- admissions counselors
- admissions processors
- evaluators
- transfer specialists
- trust analysts
- decision directors
- operations admins

Product Principles

1. Own the daily workflow, not every source system.
2. Integrate for signals; build for decisions and action.
3. Make transcripts a conversion asset, not just a document requirement.
4. Keep every recommendation explainable.
5. Make trust and provenance first-class.
6. Route work to the right human or agent.
7. Respect institutional systems of record.
8. Build role-complete workflows only where crtfy Student can be best in class.

What We Should Integrate

Marketing And CRM

Use third-party systems for broad marketing automation. For smaller schools, crtfy Student should be able to serve as the admissions CRM of record for inquiry, applicant, decision, yield, and handoff operations. For larger schools, crtfy Student should integrate with the existing admissions CRM and act as the execution layer above it.

Priority integrations:

- HubSpot for smaller and mid-market schools that want modern marketing automation.
- Slate for higher-ed-native CRM environments.
- Element451 for enrollment marketing and engagement signals.

- Salesforce for institutions already standardized on Salesforce.

What we should own when replacing the admissions CRM:

- inquiry record
- prospect and applicant profile
- source and campaign attribution
- counselor owner
- territory or segment assignment
- application status
- checklist state
- interaction history
- decision status
- yield and melt work state

What we should consume when coexisting with a CRM:

- lead source
- inquiry date
- campaign/source attribution
- event attendance
- email/SMS engagement summary
- recent web or portal activity
- counselor owner
- application-start status
- application-submitted status

What we should send back when coexisting with a CRM:

- transcript received
- checklist status
- readiness status
- trust hold
- decision recommendation status
- admitted/yield risk
- melt risk
- next best action

What we should not build:

- visual email builder

- full campaign cadence builder
- marketing landing page CMS
- event registration engine
- mass texting platform

Recommended model:

- crtfy Student owns admissions operations and the applicant record.
- HubSpot owns marketing automation, campaigns, forms, landing pages, and nurture.
- The SIS owns official student, registration, billing, and academic records.

SIS And Records

Integrate, do not replace.

Priority systems:

- Ellucian Banner
- Ellucian Colleague
- PeopleSoft Campus Solutions
- Jenzabar
- Workday Student where required by customer demand

What we should consume:

- official person identifiers
- application status
- program and term catalog data
- residency or student type where available
- deposit events
- registration or orientation milestones

What we should send:

- decision packet summary
- transcript processing status
- accepted credit estimate or handoff package
- final decision release event
- student-level handoff readiness
- sync status and errors

What we should not build:

- registration
- billing
- official academic record maintenance
- degree audit as system of record
- transcript ordering
- financial ledger

12 Month North Star

By the end of 12 months, a school should be able to run the admissions execution workflow in crtfy Student while keeping its CRM, SIS, financial aid, and communications systems in place.

The measurable outcomes:

- reduce transcript/document processing time
- reduce incomplete-application aging
- reduce time from complete file to decision
- increase transfer application conversion
- increase admit-to-deposit conversion
- reduce melt caused by missed milestones
- reduce manual spreadsheet work
- reduce ambiguous handoffs between admissions, registrar, aid, and academic units

Roadmap Summary

Quarter	Theme	Market Outcome
Q1	Make admissions work executable	Staff can work incomplete apps, documents, and review queues without spreadsheets
Q2	Become the transcript intelligence leader	Transfer, evaluation, trust, and decision workflows become best in class
Q3	Win yield and handoff	Schools can protect deposits and prevent enrollment handoff failures
Q4	Scale through integrations and intelligence	crtfy Student becomes the operating layer above CRM, SIS, and engagement systems

Q1: Months 1-3 - Make Admissions Work Executable

Goal

Turn the current product into the daily system of action for admissions operations.

Strategic Bet

The fastest path to market credibility is not more dashboards. It is letting admissions employees finish real work in the product.

Month 1: Checklist And Completion Engine

Build:

- checklist templates by population:
 - first-year
 - transfer
 - graduate
 - international
 - readmit
 - dual credit
- required vs optional checklist items
- item aging
- due dates
- received, needs review, waived, complete, and blocked states
- source document linkage
- confidence score for auto-completed items
- completeness rules by population, program, and term

Ship:

- checklist template admin
- student checklist detail
- readiness reason detail
- audit history for checklist changes

Win condition:

- staff can tell exactly why an applicant is incomplete and what action will make the file complete.

Month 2: Document-To-Checklist Automation

Build:

- received-not-indexed queue
- document-to-student matching confidence
- document-to-checklist matching
- auto-complete high-confidence checklist items
- route low-confidence items to human review
- duplicate document detection
- document processing SLA aging
- batch intake operations for transcript packages

Improve:

- Documents Queue filters
- exception reason taxonomy
- reprocess and replacement workflows
- action history readability

Win condition:

- transcript processing directly moves applicants forward without staff manually reconciling every file.

Month 3: Counselor Workbench And Outreach Logging

Build:

- Today's Work as a true operator console
- owner-specific daily queues
- one-click action logging:
 - called
 - emailed
 - texted
 - left voicemail
 - student replied
 - appointment booked
 - document requested
- manual note and next follow-up date
- basic SLA tracking by owner

- stale item resurfacing
- route-to-owner and route-to-team actions

Integrate:

- HubSpot activity sync for logged outreach where HubSpot is used.
- Slate or CRM activity export where institution requires it.

Win condition:

- counselors can work incomplete applications from crtfy Student without maintaining a side spreadsheet.

Q1 Launch Package

Package name:

- crtfy Student Operations

Buyer promise:

- Complete more applications with fewer manual handoffs.

Key demo:

1. A transcript arrives.
2. crtfy Student matches it to a student.
3. Checklist updates automatically.
4. Today's Work moves the student from incomplete to ready.
5. Counselor logs the required follow-up.

Q2: Months 4-6 - Become The Transcript Intelligence Leader

Goal

Own the workflows where crtfy Student can be clearly better than a CRM or SIS: transcript intelligence, transfer evidence, trust, and explainable decisions.

Month 4: Duplicate Resolution And Identity Confidence

Build:

- duplicate candidate queue
- match confidence and match reason display
- side-by-side candidate comparison
- field-level merge controls
- source-of-truth selection
- source correction workflow
- merge audit log
- unsafe merge prevention

Add signals:

- same email
- same phone
- same date of birth where available
- similar name
- same source document
- same external ID conflict
- same sending institution

Win condition:

- admissions operations can clean records safely without waiting on IT or manually reconciling duplicate files.

Month 5: Transfer And Articulation Workbench

Build:

- transfer specialist queue
- articulation gap detection
- syllabus-needed workflow
- equivalency review status
- course-level transcript evidence
- accepted credit estimate versioning
- transfer pathway preview
- specialist notes
- return-to-counselor and return-to-student actions

Integrate:

- SIS articulation tables where available.
- Transferology or equivalent data only as a reference signal where customers have access.

Do not build:

- official degree audit system
- registrar-owned academic record of record

Win condition:

- a transfer-heavy institution can use crtfy Student to produce faster, clearer transfer-credit confidence before final SIS handoff.

Month 6: Decision Release And Policy Controls

Build:

- final decision release workflow
- release gates:
 - checklist complete
 - trust cleared
 - decision recommendation reviewed
 - required approvals complete
- hold, release, deny, admit, admit with condition, waitlist, defer, revoke, reopen
- decision letter trigger integration
- portal-facing release status integration
- policy-based approval matrix
- reviewer claim/reassign
- return-to-incomplete
- decision packet version comparison

Win condition:

- evaluators and directors can move from evidence review to defensible decision release without leaving the operating workflow.

Q2 Launch Package

Package name:

- crtfy Student Decision Intelligence

Buyer promise:

- Make faster, more defensible admissions and transfer decisions.

Key demo:

1. A duplicate record is detected.
2. Processor resolves it with field-level merge.
3. Transfer specialist clears an articulation gap.
4. Decision agent generates a recommendation.
5. Director releases the decision after gates pass.

Q3: Months 7-9 - Win Yield And Handoff

Goal

Move beyond processing speed into enrollment outcome ownership.

Strategic Bet

Schools will pay more when crtfy Student can prove it protects enrollment, not just staff efficiency.

Month 7: Admitted Student Action System

Build:

- admitted-student priority queue
- yield risk reason codes
- next intervention recommendation
- intervention logging
- scholarship-sensitive flag
- transfer-credit-value flag
- recent engagement summary from CRM
- no-recent-touch alerts
- counselor ownership dashboard

Integrate:

- HubSpot, Slate, or Element451 engagement summary.

- Event attendance and campaign engagement as read-only signals.

Do not build:

- full admitted-student campaign builder
- event management system

Win condition:

- counselors know which admitted students to contact today and why.

Month 8: Deposit And Melt Prevention

Build:

- deposit event capture from SIS or CRM
- post-admit milestone model:
 - FAFSA
 - aid package
 - housing
 - orientation
 - final transcript
 - immunization if configured
 - advising
 - registration
- milestone owner by office
- milestone update action
- follow-up logging
- cross-office notes
- melt risk reason codes
- aging and missed-milestone alerts

Win condition:

- admissions, aid, registrar, and advising can see the same risk picture without crtfy Student becoming any of those systems.

Month 9: Handoff Command Center

Build:

- student-level handoff status
- downstream sync status
- office-by-office readiness:
 - admissions
 - registrar
 - financial aid
 - advising
 - housing/orientation where configured
- handoff package
- sync error queue
- retry and acknowledge workflow
- integration run history
- unresolved handoff risk queue

Integrate:

- SIS handoff event.
- CRM outcome update.
- Financial aid milestone feed where available.

Win condition:

- leadership can see which admitted or deposited students are at risk because an operational handoff failed.

Q3 Launch Package

Package name:

- crtfy Student Yield And Handoff

Buyer promise:

- Protect deposits and prevent enrollment misses caused by operational gaps.

Key demo:

1. Student is admitted.
2. crtfy Student identifies high yield potential but no recent touch.
3. Counselor logs intervention.
4. Deposit event arrives.
5. Melt queue detects missing orientation and final transcript.

6. Handoff Command Center shows registrar sync error and retry.

Q4: Months 10-12 - Scale Through Integrations And Intelligence

Goal

Make crtfy Student the scalable operating layer across different institution types and systems.

Month 10: Integration Marketplace And Implementation Console

Build:

- integration marketplace
- connector setup status
- field mapping UI
- sync health dashboard
- tenant implementation checklist
- data quality warnings
- source-system event log
- permission and sensitivity validation

Priority connectors:

- HubSpot
- Slate
- Element451
- Salesforce
- Banner
- Colleague
- PeopleSoft Campus Solutions
- document imaging or SFTP intake

Win condition:

- implementation teams can connect crtfy Student without turning every deployment into a custom project.

Month 11: Intelligence Layer And Benchmarks

Build:

- explainable priority score tuning
- institution-level funnel benchmarks
- queue aging benchmarks
- decision speed benchmarks
- transfer turnaround benchmarks
- document automation rate
- trust hold rate
- staff workload distribution
- forecasted enrollment risk
- model performance monitoring

Keep explainability mandatory:

- every score must show reason codes
- every agent action must show source evidence
- every recommendation must be reviewable

Win condition:

- leadership can manage admissions execution using trusted operational intelligence, not black-box scores.

Month 12: Graduate And Program Review Expansion

Build:

- graduate admissions workspace
- program-level queues
- faculty committee packet view
- rubric review
- committee recommendation
- assistantship/fellowship flag
- program coordinator workflow
- central graduate school handoff
- department-level permissions

Do not overbuild:

- no full faculty governance platform
- no academic department ERP

Win condition:

- crtfy Student can support graduate admissions without forcing the undergraduate territory model onto faculty-led review.

Q4 Launch Package

Package name:

- crtfy Student Platform

Buyer promise:

- Run admissions execution across systems, populations, and offices with explainable intelligence.

Key demo:

1. HubSpot supplies engagement.
2. SIS supplies deposit and student ID.
3. crtfy Student prioritizes work.
4. Decision and handoff status sync back.
5. Leadership sees benchmarked execution performance.
6. Graduate program committee reviews a packet in its own workspace.

Role Completeness Targets

By month 12, these roles should be able to complete the crtfy-owned portion of their work inside the app.

Role	Target completeness	What crtfy Student should own
Admissions counselor	High	Daily work, incomplete movement, logged outreach, yield/melt interventions
Admissions processor	Very high	Document intake, indexing, matching, reprocessing, duplicate resolution

Role	Target completeness	What crtfy Student should own
Evaluator	High	Review queue, evidence review, recommendation review, request evidence
Decision director	High	Release gates, approvals, final decision workflow, reporting
Trust analyst	Very high	Trust investigation, block/unblock, escalation, resolution, audit trail
Transfer specialist	High	Articulation gaps, transfer evidence, credit estimate, specialist routing
Financial aid	Medium	Aid milestone visibility and handoff risk, not aid processing
Registrar	Medium	Handoff readiness and sync exceptions, not official record ownership
Leadership	High	Operational metrics, forecasts, benchmarks, accountability
CRM/admin/integration staff	Medium-high	Connector health, mappings, sync errors, data quality
Graduate coordinator/faculty	Medium-high	Program review workflow and committee recommendations

Packaging Strategy

Package 1: Operations

For institutions that need application completion and document processing relief.

Includes:

- Today's Work
- Student 360
- checklist engine
- Documents Queue

- duplicate resolution
- basic reporting

Package 2: Decision Intelligence

For institutions that need faster, more defensible review.

Includes:

- Decision Studio
- transfer workbench
- trust center
- decision release gates
- recommendation snapshots
- audit trail

Package 3: Yield And Handoff

For institutions focused on enrollment outcomes.

Includes:

- Admitted / Yield
- Deposit / Melt
- milestone tracking
- handoff command center
- CRM engagement signals
- SIS deposit and sync signals

Package 4: Platform

For larger or more complex institutions.

Includes:

- integration marketplace
- implementation console
- benchmarks
- advanced reporting
- graduate/program review
- multi-office workflows

Pricing Logic

Pricing should reflect operational value, not seat count alone.

Recommended structure:

- platform fee by institution size
- applicant volume tier
- premium connector fees for SIS/CRM integrations
- add-on modules for Decision Intelligence, Yield/Handoff, and Graduate Review
- implementation fee based on connector complexity

Avoid pricing only by user seat. Admissions teams are cross-functional, and seat pricing discourages the exact collaboration the product needs to create.

Data Model Priorities

Build these durable entities:

- student_identity
- student_source_refs
- student_population
- checklist_templates
- student_checklist_items
- documents
- document_matches
- duplicate_candidates
- student_work_items
- student_signals
- student_priority_scores
- decision_packets
- decision_reviews
- decision_releases
- trust_cases
- transfer_articulation_cases
- student_interactions
- student_milestones
- student_handoff_status
- integration_connections

- integration_runs
- sync_errors
- audit_events

Agent Strategy

Agents should accelerate work, not hide institutional judgment.

Document Agent

Own:

- parsing
- persistence
- checklist linkage
- exception classification
- match confidence

Trust Agent

Own:

- provenance signals
- risk summaries
- recommended action
- case state transitions

Decision Agent

Own:

- decision context assembly
- recommendation generation
- rationale
- evidence summary
- snapshot creation

Orchestrator Agent

Own:

- Today's Work prioritization
- route recommendation
- stale work resurfacing
- owner workload balancing

Lifecycle Agent

Own:

- yield risk
- melt risk
- milestone risk
- next intervention recommendation

Integration Agent

Own:

- sync health summaries
- mapping validation
- handoff error classification
- retry recommendations

Competitive Moat

The moat should be built around workflow-specific intelligence and operational trust.

Moat components:

- transcript parsing and academic evidence graph
- trust/provenance workflow
- decision packet versioning and explainability
- cross-system student work state
- handoff risk and sync intelligence
- role-aware operating queues
- integration mappings across CRM/SIS/document ecosystems
- benchmark data around document, decision, yield, and melt performance

Do not chase moat in:

- generic email marketing
- generic CRM records
- SIS replacement
- generic dashboards
- chatbot novelty

Sales Story By Buyer

VP Enrollment

Message:

- Increase enrollment execution without replacing your CRM or SIS.

Proof:

- faster completion
- faster decision
- higher yield
- lower melt
- fewer handoff failures

Director Of Admissions

Message:

- Give every counselor and processor one daily queue that tells them what to do next.

Proof:

- fewer spreadsheets
- clearer ownership
- better queue aging
- cleaner handoffs

Admissions Operations

Message:

- Stop chasing documents manually.

Proof:

- document-to-checklist automation
- duplicate resolution
- exception queues
- audit trails

Transfer Leadership

Message:

- Turn transfer credit uncertainty into a conversion advantage.

Proof:

- faster credit estimates
- articulation gap queue
- explainable credit evidence

CIO / IT

Message:

- We integrate with your systems of record and reduce shadow process risk.

Proof:

- no SIS replacement
- clear APIs
- tenant security
- sync logs
- audit trails

Implementation Strategy

First 30 Days Of A Customer

Target:

- go live with Today's Work, Student 360, Documents Queue, and checklist movement.

Steps:

1. Connect identity and tenant access.
2. Import active applicants and checklist data.
3. Configure populations and checklist templates.
4. Configure document intake.
5. Train processors and counselors.
6. Launch with incomplete and document queues.

First 60 Days

Target:

- expand to Decision Studio, Trust Center, and duplicate resolution.

First 90 Days

Target:

- expand to yield/melt and CRM/SIS signal integrations.

Success Metrics

Product Usage

- daily active admissions users
- work items completed per user
- checklist items completed through automation
- documents processed per day
- decisions reviewed per day
- trust cases resolved
- outreach actions logged

Operational Outcomes

- incomplete application aging
- transcript turnaround time
- document exception rate
- duplicate resolution time
- complete-to-decision time

- admit-to-deposit conversion
- melt risk resolution
- handoff sync error aging

Business Outcomes

- application completion rate
- transfer application conversion
- admitted student yield
- deposited student enrollment rate
- staff hours saved
- implementation time
- module attach rate

What Not To Build In The Next 12 Months

Avoid these even if customers ask in early conversations:

- full SIS replacement
- registration
- billing
- official academic record maintenance
- full financial aid processing
- full marketing CRM replacement
- full marketing automation suite
- event registration platform
- chatbot platform
- student mobile app as a primary product
- generalized data warehouse
- generic BI tool

If needed, integrate with systems that already do these jobs.

Final 12 Month Outcome

At the end of 12 months, crtfy Student should be credible as the best admissions execution product for schools that care about speed, trust, transfer, decision quality, and enrollment outcomes.

The product should let a school say:

- our counselors know who to work every day
- our processors are not buried in document chaos
- our evaluators have defensible evidence
- our trust risks are visible and controlled
- our transfer students get faster certainty
- our admitted students do not disappear after the decision
- our SIS remains the system of record
- our CRM remains the engagement system
- crtfy Student is where admissions work gets done